DESK BRIEF - Sunday, Nov 1, 2026 - Global

Cross-Asset Summary

- Dominant driver: three G10 central banks leaned hawkish in one week. The Fed held at 3.75-4.00% with two dissents for a 25bp hike (FI1, FI3), the BoC hiked 25bp to 2.50% (FX24), and the BoJ held at 1.25% with a dissent for 1.5% and language that underlying inflation is consistent with 2% (FX1, FX3, FX8). December Fed-hike odds are not yet confirmed; snapshots span 68.4%-86% (FI18).
- Data ran hot: Q3 GDP 3.4% annualized (CM20), core PCE 3.1% YoY (CM19), Brent at a six-month high of $117.64 (CM30).
- Gold hit a one-year low and silver broke $50 (CM1, CM10) after five weeks of speculative long cuts (CM25).
- Alphabet fell 12.6% in a day (EQ7); Nasdaq -2.0% w/w, Russell +1.3% (EQ14, EQ15).
- Binance lost about $6.3bn to a hack, still developing (DA2, DA7).

Risk Dashboard

Asset class	Week-on-week move (claim ID)	Key level (claim ID)	Risk flag	Confidence	Next catalyst (date, claim ID)
Fixed Income	10y UST -6 to -7bp, conflicting (FI7); HY OAS -12bp (FI15)	10y 4.93-4.94%, conflicting (FI7); HY OAS 326bp (FI13)	Medium - below 15bp threshold; dated catalyst	Low - KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED	ISM Nov 2 (FI25)
FX	n/a - no benchmark move sourced (FX15, FX17)	USD/JPY 157.56 (FX10)	Low - no sourced w/w move	Medium - one conflict (FX14)	BoE/RBA week of Nov 2, unconfirmed (FX33)
Equities	S&P 500 -0.6% (EQ13); Nasdaq -2.0% (EQ14); Russell 2000 +1.3% (EQ15)	S&P 500 7,580.07 (EQ12)	High - Nasdaq at 2% threshold AND Apple Nov 2	Low - Developing story: yes	Apple Nov 2 (EQ17)
Cash & Equivalents	4-week bill -3.6bp auction-to-auction (CA9b); MMF AUM -$43.29bn (CA34)	4-week 3.976% (CA9a); MMF AUM $7,901.28bn (CA33)	Medium - below thresholds; dated catalyst	Low - KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED	13w/26w bills Nov 2 (CA28, CA29)
Commodities & Precious Metals	Gold futures -2.7% (CM7); Brent conflicting (CM47)	Dec gold $3,898.90 (CM5); Brent Dec $117.64 (CM44)	Medium - 3% threshold not confirmed; dated catalyst	Low - Developing story: yes; KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED	Payrolls Nov 6 (CM32)
Digital & Alternatives	Bitcoin -4.0% to -4.45% (DA14)	BTC intraday low $76,141 (DA11)	Medium - below 7% threshold; dated catalyst	Low - Developing story: yes; KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED	Proof of reserves Nov 2/3, conflicting (DA29)

Asset Class Reports

Fixed Income

Headline [U.S. Treasuries / Fed]: Fed holds at 3.75-4.00% with two hawkish dissents; the 10y ends the week lower through heavy supply.

What happened: The FOMC held at 3.75-4.00% on Oct 28 by 10-2, Cook and Hammack preferring a 25bp hike (FI1, FI2, FI3),. The 10y closed Friday at 4.93-4.94%, down 6-7bp w/w, not yet confirmed (FI7). Wolf Street reports $907bn of Treasury sales (FI10); the 7y cleared at 4.894% with a 0.0bp tail, the gap to the

when-issued yield, and a 57.8% indirect share vs a 63.7% average (FI11b, FI11d). HY OAS, the index spread over Treasuries, tightened 12bp on the week to 326bp but widened 12bp on Oct 29 (FI13, FI14, FI15).

Portfolio implications (implications): - Duration: pro-hike dissents and 3.1% core PCE (FI3, FI20) beside a falling 10y (FI7) argue for reviewing duration adds against December pricing (FI18). - Credit: a one-day 12bp HY reversal after a week of tightening (FI14, FI15) suggests monitoring HY beta (FI13). - Liquidity: a lower indirect share at the 7y (FI11d) argues for monitoring foreign demand at next week's auctions (CA28-CA31).

Cross-asset read-across: The same hike-odds repricing drove gold to a one-year low (FI18, CM1).

What to watch: ISM Nov 2 (FI25); midterms Nov 3 (FI23); payrolls Nov 6 (FI22); FOMC Dec 9 (FI21).

Confidence: Low - KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED (10y weekly move; supply total).

Sources: Federal Reserve; Wolf Street; investingLive.

Headline [Sovereigns / BoJ, ECB]: BoJ holds at 1.25% with a dissent for 1.5%; ECB holds as Lagarde sets an early exit.

What happened: The BoJ held at around 1.25% on Oct 30 by 8-1, Takata proposing 1.5% (FI26, FI27, FI28), and set ETF sales at about JPY 860bn a year (FI29). XTB reports the ECB held its deposit rate at 2.50% with euro-area inflation at 3.8% YoY (FI31, FI32); Lagarde leaves Feb 7, 2027 (FI33).

Portfolio implications (implications): Duration - a dissent for a higher rate (FI28) argues for reviewing JGB exposure before Dec 17-18 (FX31). Allocation - an ECB on hold at 3.8% inflation with a leadership change (FI32, FI33) argues for monitoring Bund term premium.

Cross-asset read-across: BoJ ETF sales (FI29) are equity supply.

What to watch: BoE Nov 5 (FI24).

Confidence: Low - KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED (ECB rate single-sourced).

Sources: Bank of Japan; XTB.

FX

Headline [G10 majors / JPY, USD, CAD]: Three hawkish G10 decisions in one week; yen posts a third straight daily gain while the dollar holds its October rise.

What happened: The BoJ held at 1.25% by 8-1 with Takata proposing 1.5% (FX1, FX2, FX3), raised its FY2027 core CPI median to 2.6% from 2.4% (FX4, FX5), said underlying inflation is generally consistent with 2% (FX8), and more than doubled ETF sales from January 2027 (FX9a, FX9c). Trading Economics reports USD/JPY closed at 157.5605 Friday (FX10), the yen's third consecutive daily gain (FX13); its October move is not yet confirmed (FX14). Reuters reports DXY at 101.86 intraday Friday, up 0.39% month-to-date (FX15, FX16). The BoC hiked 25bp to 2.50%, its first since July 2023 (FX24); XTB reports USD/CAD near 1.4040 with little reaction (FX25). Reuters reports EUR/USD at an 18-month low (FX28).

Portfolio implications (implications): - FX: the Policy Board median, the median of members' forecasts, at 2.6% (FX4), with BeInCrypto reporting 54 of 78 Reuters-poll economists expecting a December hike (FX30), argues for reviewing unhedged yen shorts before Dec 17-18 (FX31). - Hedging: a BoC hike met by a flat USD/CAD (FX24, FX25) suggests monitoring whether CAD hedges price further tightening. - Allocation: EUR/USD at an 18-month low while the ECB holds (FX28, FX29) argues for reviewing euro exposure (FX16).

Cross-asset read-across: BoJ ETF sales (FX9a) touch Japanese equities.

What to watch: BoE and RBA, week of Nov 2, dates unconfirmed (FX33); Fed and BoC Dec 9 (FX32); BoJ Dec 17-18 (FX31).

Confidence: Medium - one conflict in Gaps (FX14).

Sources: Bank of Japan; Reuters via Star-Advertiser; BeInCrypto; Trading Economics.

Equities

Headline [Mega-cap technology]: Alphabet's record one-day drop and Amazon's EPS miss put AI capex on trial; Nasdaq -2.0% w/w while small caps gain. Still developing; details may change.

What happened: Alphabet's Q3 revenue was $127.6B, up 25% YoY (EQ1), with Cloud up 103% (EQ3), but capex of $51.4B (EQ5) pushed free cash flow, operating cash flow minus capex, to -$9.07B (EQ4); shares fell 12.6% on Oct 29, a record one-day drop (EQ7). Amazon's $201.9B net sales missed consensus (EQ9a), AWS grew 39% (EQ9d), Q4 operating-income guidance trailed expectations (EQ9f), and trailing free cash flow was an outflow of $42.4B (EQ9h); shares fell about 6% after hours (EQ10). The S&P 500 fell 0.6% w/w to 7,580.07 (EQ12, EQ13); the Nasdaq fell 2.0% w/w (EQ14); the Russell 2000 rose 1.3% w/w (EQ15).

Portfolio implications (implications): - Equity beta: a 2% Nasdaq weekly loss against a rising Russell 2000 and The Glass Desk's RSP +0.82% (EQ14, EQ15, EQ22) argues for reviewing cap-weighted concentration. - Allocation: Investomine reports $5.5B of technology-fund inflows the same week as $6.65B of US equity-fund outflows (EQ21); monitor whether tech inflows persist after EQ7. - Hedging: Apple Nov 2 and payrolls Nov 6 (EQ17, EQ18) follow a Fed hold with hawkish dissents (EQ16); consider event hedges.

Cross-asset read-across: Hyperscaler cash outflows (EQ4, EQ9h) are an issuance question for IG credit (FI16).

What to watch: Apple Nov 2 (EQ17); midterms Nov 3 (EQ19); payrolls Nov 6 (EQ18).

Confidence: Low - Developing story: yes.

Sources: Alphabet; Amazon; AFP via Gulf News; The Glass Desk.

Cash & Equivalents

Headline [T-bills / front end]: Treasury sells a reported $670bn of bills into a Fed hold; auction yields edge lower.

What happened: The FOMC held at 3.75-4.00% (CA1) with two dissents for a hike (CA3). Wolf Street reports $670bn of bills sold in the week (CA8), not yet confirmed against TreasuryDirect. The 4-week bill cleared at a 3.976% investment rate, the coupon-equivalent yield (CA9a), which tftc.io reports was 3.6bp below Oct 22 (CA9b). The 26-week cleared at 4.361% (CA12a); tftc.io reports bid-to-cover, bids divided by amount accepted, at 2.63x vs 2.84x prior (CA12c).

Portfolio implications (implications): - Liquidity: a 26-week bid-to-cover of 2.63x (CA12c) during heavy supply (CA8) argues for monitoring the Nov 2-5 auctions (CA28-CA31). - Duration: front-end yields easing (CA9b) while futures price a high December-hike probability, not yet confirmed (CA20, CA22), leaves reinvestment rates open into Dec 8-9 (CA26). - Allocation: Crane reports a 3.75% fund yield (CA24) below the 4.361% 26-week bill (CA12a); consider the term trade-off.

Cross-asset read-across: Bill supply (CA8) competes with 7y demand (FI11d).

What to watch: 13w/26w bills Nov 2 (CA28, CA29); 4w/8w bills Nov 5 (CA31); FOMC Dec 8-9 (CA26).

Confidence: Low - KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED (supply totals, front-end closes).

Sources: Federal Reserve; Wolf Street; tftc.io.

Headline [Money market funds]: MMF assets fall $43.3bn to $7.90tn in the week to Oct 28.

What happened: ICI total MMF assets were $7,901.28bn on Oct 28 (CA33), down $43.29bn w/w (CA34), institutional funds -$33.66bn (CA36). Crane reports MMF Treasury holdings fell $164.4bn in September (CA42) while repo rose (CA43). SwitchWize reports a 5.00% best CD APY (CA46).

Portfolio implications (implications): Liquidity - institutional outflows (CA36) plus a September cut in MMF Treasury holdings (CA42) argue for monitoring who absorbs bill supply (CA8). Allocation - a 5.00% CD against a 3.75% fund yield (CA46, CA24) suggests reviewing term deposits.

Cross-asset read-across: MMFs rotating into repo (CA43) bears on bill demand (CA12c).

What to watch: FOMC Dec 8-9 (CA26).

Confidence: Low - held with the class at the Checkpoint.

Sources: ICI; Crane Data.

Commodities & Precious Metals

Headline [Gold, silver]: Gold at a one-year low, silver below $50, as hot PCE and $117 Brent firm December-hike bets. Still developing; details may change.

What happened: Spot gold hit a one-year low on Oct 30 (CM1), down about 3.5% d/d (CM4); December futures settled at $3,898.90 (CM5), down 2.7% w/w (CM7), with spot weekly and October figures not yet confirmed (CM9). Silver broke $50 for the first time since November 2025 (CM10), down about 6% d/d (CM11); Kitco reports nearly 9% w/w (CM12). September headline PCE rose 0.5% m/m (CM17), core 3.1% YoY (CM19). Tradingster reports the CFTC speculative net long down 13,414 w/w to 186,451 contracts (CM23, CM24), a fifth straight cut (CM25).

Portfolio implications (implications): - Allocation: five weeks of speculative selling (CM25) into a one-year low (CM1) argues for reviewing whether gold hedges are cut at peak hike consensus (CM22). - Hedging: silver's near-9% weekly drop (CM12) suggests monitoring silver beta separately. - Duration: a 0.5% monthly headline PCE print (CM17) with Brent at $117.64 (CM30) also bears on Treasuries (FI20).

Cross-asset read-across: Gold's fall tracks hike odds priced in rates and FX (CM22, FX23).

What to watch: Payrolls Nov 6 (CM32); CPI Nov 10, unconfirmed (CM34); FOMC Dec 8-9 (CM33).

Confidence: Low - Developing story: yes; KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED (CFTC net long).

Sources: Reuters via The Standard; Kitco; Tradingster.

Headline [Crude oil / OPEC+]: OPEC+ subgroup leaves December targets unchanged as Brent ends October at a six-month high. Still developing; details may change.

What happened: Seven OPEC+ members kept December targets unchanged on Nov 1 (CM36); Argus says output trails targets by about 4.21m b/d (CM40). Brent December settled at $117.64 on Oct 30 (CM44), January at $113.43 (CM45); weekly and monthly gains are not yet confirmed (CM47, CM49), though October was a fourth straight monthly gain (CM51). DTN reports 43 UKMTO Gulf incidents in October (CM52).

Portfolio implications (implications): Hedging - unchanged quotas with output 4m b/d below target (CM36, CM40) cap the supply response; consider energy as an inflation hedge (CM18). Allocation - Brent January vs the expired December contract (CM44, CM45) argues for monitoring roll costs.

Cross-asset read-across: Oil's monthly PCE channel (CM17) feeds Fed-hike odds (CM22).

What to watch: OPEC+ Nov 29 (CM43).

Confidence: Low - Developing story: yes; KEY FACT UNCONFIRMED (no OPEC primary release opened).

Sources: Reuters via Business Standard; Briefs.co; DTN.

Digital & Alternatives

Headline [Cryptocurrencies / exchanges, ETFs]: Record Binance hack sends bitcoin to a six-week low; spot ETFs flip to a weekly net outflow. Still developing; details may change.

What happened: Unauthorized withdrawals from Binance hot wallets began at about 20:05 UTC on Oct 29 (DA1); the total stolen is not yet confirmed, estimates spanning $5.9bn to $6.43bn with Binance citing about $6.3bn (DA2). Binance says it will cover all user losses from its SAFU fund, an emergency reserve (DA5); withdrawals were still suspended late Oct 30 (DA7). Bitcoin's Friday low was $76,141 (DA11), down about 4.0-4.45% over seven days (DA14). Spot bitcoin ETFs saw about $643m of outflows Friday (DA15), turning the week to about -$202m (DA16). Galaxy Research says nine hedge funds and banks cut about 68,000 BTC of ETF exposure through June (DA22). No other sub-segment cleared the gate.

Portfolio implications (implications): - Liquidity: 18,270 BTC in attacker hands that no issuer can freeze (DA3) and Cointribune's $1.3bn of liquidations (DA19) argue for monitoring exchange liquidity before adding. - Allocation: fast money had already left ETFs and futures (DA22, DA23, DA24); 24/7 Wall St's Fear & Greed

reading of 36 (DA20) makes sentiment the fresh variable. - Hedging: proof of reserves on Nov 2 or 3, conflicting (DA29), is a binary event; consider sizing crypto risk to it.

Cross-asset read-across: The hack lands in a hawkish-Fed week (DA26), compressing risk appetite and carry (DA25).

What to watch: Withdrawals target Nov 1 (DA28); proof of reserves Nov 2/3 (DA29); 13F deadline Nov 16 (DA32).

Confidence: Low - Developing story: yes.

Sources: Help Net Security; The Hacker News; Cointribune; 24/7 Wall St.

Watchlist - Next 7 Days

Date	Event	Asset class(es) affected	Why it matters	Claim ID
Mon Nov 2	ISM manufacturing, 10:00 ET	Fixed Income, FX	First activity print after the Fed hold	FI25
Mon Nov 2	13-week and 26-week bill auctions	Cash	Demand test after a 2.63x bid-to-cover	CA28, CA29
Mon Nov 2	Apple FQ4 results, after close	Equities	Third mega-cap print after Alphabet and Amazon	EQ17
Nov 2-3	Binance proof of reserves (date conflicting)	Digital	Reserve attestation	DA29
Tue Nov 3	US midterm elections	All	CLARITY Act pending; regulatory read-across	FI23, DA30
Thu Nov 5	Bank of England decision; 4w/8w bill auctions	Fixed Income, FX, Cash	Fourth G10 decision; reinvestment rate	FI24, CA31
Fri Nov 6	US October payrolls, 8:30 ET	All	Largest single input to December-hike odds	FI22

Reverse Trade (scenario analysis, not forecast)

1. December Fed hike - Priced: futures-implied odds of a 25bp hike on Dec 9 are not yet confirmed, but every snapshot sits between 68.4% and 86% (FI18); BeInCrypto reports 74.9% on CME FedWatch (FX23), up from 73.3% a week earlier (CM22). - Positioning evidence: sourced (FI18, FX23, CM22). - Reverse scenario: payrolls and ISM soften enough that the two dissents (FI3) stay a minority and December is a hold. - Catalysts: ISM Nov 2 (FI25); payrolls Nov 6 (FI22); CPI Nov 10, unconfirmed (CM34); FOMC Dec 9 (FI21). - Data points to monitor: 2y at 4.56-4.61%, conflicting (FI9); 10y 4.93-4.94% (FI7); the 68.4% Friday reading (FI18). - Portfolio read: the crowded expression is cash and front-end overweights waiting for a higher reinvestment rate (CA22) and the gold underweight (CM25); a hold would reprice duration, gold and the yen together, so review how much of the book leans one way.

2. AI capex is value-destroying - Priced: Alphabet's 12.6% one-day drop (EQ7) and Amazon's 6% after-hours fall (EQ10) against a Nasdaq -2.0%, Russell +1.3% week (EQ14, EQ15); yet Investomine reports $5.5B of technology-fund inflows (EQ21). - Positioning evidence: sourced (EQ21, EQ22). - Reverse scenario: Apple's print (EQ17) and the 103% Cloud and 39% AWS growth rates (EQ3, EQ9d) reassert the revenue case; the rotation reverses. - Catalysts: Apple Nov 2 (EQ17); 13F filings Nov 16 (DA32). - Data points to monitor: Nasdaq 25,437.00 (EQ14); RSP +0.82% vs QQQ -1.97% weekly spread (EQ22). - Portfolio read: the exposed position is the fresh small-cap and equal-weight rotation (EQ15, EQ22); consider whether it is a one-week event.

3. Crypto contagion from Binance - Priced: a $643m single-day ETF outflow (DA15), $1.3bn of liquidations per Cointribune (DA19), a Fear & Greed reading of 36 per 24/7 Wall St (DA20). - Positioning evidence: sourced (DA20, DA22, DA23, DA24). - Reverse scenario: withdrawals resume (DA28), proof of reserves lands (DA29), Binance covers losses (DA5, DA6), and the sellers were already out (DA22). - Catalysts: withdrawals Nov 1 (DA28); proof of reserves Nov 2/3 (DA29). - Data points to monitor: $76,141 intraday low

(DA11); daily ETF flows vs the -$202m week (DA16). - Portfolio read: the crowded side is the post-hack short, with leveraged-fund net shorts already cut to 30,600 BTC (DA24); argues for reviewing whether contagion shorts carry asymmetric risk.

Ignored But Important Watch

1. Who absorbs the bills if money funds step back - Why it matters: MMF assets fell $43.29bn in the week to Oct 28 (CA34), institutional -$33.66bn (CA36); Crane reports MMFs cut Treasury holdings by $164.4bn in September (CA42) while Wolf Street reports $670bn of bills sold in a week (CA8). - Why it is ignored: no independent newswire covered the ICI release and the supply total is single-sourced (CA8, CA42); coverage focused on the Fed vote (CA3). - Positioning evidence: sourced (CA12c, CA42, CA43). - Crowded side: cash and bill overweights that assume MMF demand backstops supply (CA22, CA12c). - Actionable monitor: 26-week bid-to-cover on Nov 2 vs 2.63x (CA29, CA12c); 4-week rate vs 3.976% on Nov 5 (CA31, CA9a); consider cash-sleeve exposure to bill cheapening.

2. Hormuz incidents and the oil-to-PCE channel - Why it matters: DTN reports 43 UKMTO Gulf incidents in October, 30 of them tanker strikes (CM52, CM53), Brent sits at $117.64 (CM44), and OPEC+ left targets unchanged with Argus citing 4.21m b/d of under-production (CM36, CM40). - Why it is ignored: weekly and monthly oil moves conflict across outlets (CM47, CM49) and no crude positioning was reported; headline PCE at 3.6% drew less attention than core at 3.1% (CM18, CM19). - Positioning evidence: inferred from price action (CM44, CM48, CM51). - Crowded side: long Brent after four straight monthly gains, implied by the move in CM44 and CM51; and duration longs treating core PCE as the relevant print (CM19, FI7). - Actionable monitor: OPEC+ Nov 29 (CM43); CPI Nov 10, unconfirmed (CM34); Brent January $113.43 (CM45); consider headline-inflation hedges.

3. BoJ says 2% is reached - Why it matters: the BoJ states underlying inflation is generally consistent with 2% (FX8), the FY2027 median moved to 2.6% (FX4), a member voted for 1.5% (FX3), and ETF sales double (FX9a); fattail.ai reports the 10y JGB at 2.876% (FI30). - Why it is ignored: the yen's October move is not yet confirmed and at most a 0.11-0.34% gain (FX14); no swap-implied December odds were reported. - Positioning evidence: sourced (FX30 - BeInCrypto reports 54 of 78 Reuters-poll economists expect a 1.5% hike this quarter). - Crowded side: yen-funded carry and unhedged Japanese equity longs facing BoJ ETF supply (FX30, FX9a, FX10). - Actionable monitor: BoJ Dec 17-18 (FX31) against Fed Dec 9 (FX32); USD/JPY vs 157.56 (FX10); consider reviewing yen hedge ratios.

Packet audit: 9 packets (0 NO QUALIFYING STORY), 247 claims, 134 confirmed by 2+ independent sources, 95 single-sourced or claimed (18 conflicting), 119 gap lines (10 key facts unconfirmed, 18 conflicts), 100 pages read across 70 distinct domains, 20 primary sources, Checkpoint DEGRADED: item 3, FI/EQ/CA/CM/DA packets, as of Sun Nov 1, 2026, ~6:00 PM ET. Word count: 2,896 (tags excluded).

Self-check: PASS

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